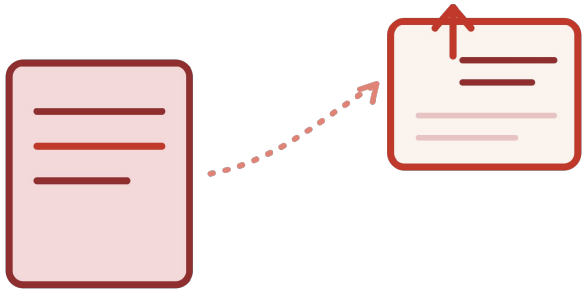
Case Study: A Lessons-Learned Report Feeding Back Into Training

The pretexting incident from Week 11 Day 1's case study produced a lessons-learned report with a direct second life.



Dominic Yeakel | 10/15/2026

1 The Report

The Report

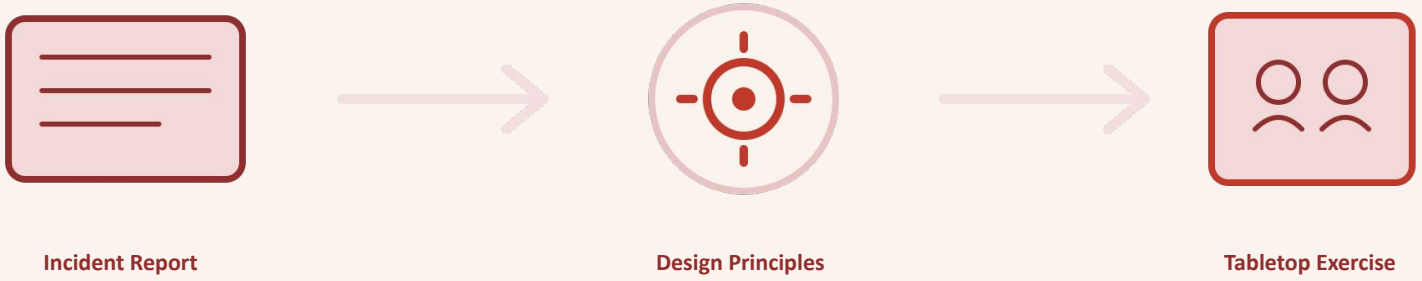
The report clearly identified the authority and urgency triggers behind the false vendor pretext, along with the exact timeline of the employee's fast, supportive reporting. This specificity is what made the report immediately usable.



2 The Reuse

The Reuse

The awareness program team used the report almost directly as new tabletop exercise material, following the training design principles from Week 10 Day 1. Very little rewriting was needed to turn a real incident into training content.



3 The Lesson

The Lesson

A well documented incident does not just close a single case, it strengthens the entire training and mitigation program going forward. This is exactly the feedback loop this whole unit has been building toward.



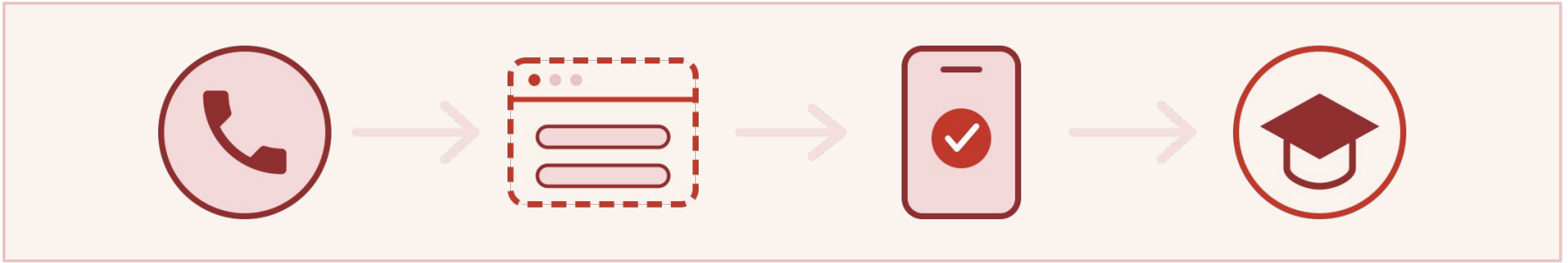
REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Twitter, July 2020: A Phone Pretext That Changed Training

Attackers phoned Twitter employees posing as the IT help desk, citing VPN problems, and sent them to a lookalike login page. Credentials entered there were relayed to the real VPN, and some employees approved the resulting second-factor prompt.

Twitter reported 130 accounts targeted, 45 tweeted from, and 36 direct message inboxes accessed.

Its response included additional company-wide training against social engineering and ongoing company-wide phishing exercises.



Help Desk Call

Lookalike VPN Page

MFA Prompt Approved

Training Added

Sources: Twitter Blog, "An update on our security incident" (July 2020); NYDFS Twitter investigation report (October 2020)

CARRYING THIS FORWARD

A single documented incident, fed back in, is what turns a training program into one that keeps improving itself.



One well documented incident today is next quarter's training material.